

ZAYNEB CHERIF

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EDUCATION

Columbia University — B.A. Computer Science & Design

Expected May 2028 | New York, NY

Relevant coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Foundations of CS, Linear Algebra, Calculus III, Principles of Data Science

University of Oxford

Aug 2026

AI and Machine Learning Summer Programme

EXPERIENCE

OpenAI

Jun – Aug 2026

AI Model Trainer, Codex • Part-time

- Improved Codex reliability by designing 50+ adversarial evaluations targeting code correctness and reasoning across edge cases and ambiguous prompts.
- Built evaluation workflows to track behavioral regressions and recurring failure patterns across prompt configurations.

MIT-Incubated Stealth AI Startup

Jun – Aug 2026

Software Engineering Intern

- Built an end-to-end AI document platform with a FastAPI backend supporting 4 file formats, real-time semantic search, and cited RAG responses.
- Engineered a 4-agent system integrating Gmail, document retrieval, fact-checking, and human-approved tool execution for enterprise clients.

Pfizer Advanced Externship

Jun – Aug 2026

Advanced AI Extern

- Scoped and built an enterprise document intelligence system for a global pharmaceutical client, combining OCR, semantic retrieval, and cited LLM responses; presented findings directly to Pfizer stakeholders.
- Designed a natural language interface enabling non-technical teams to query large document repositories without engineering support.

IBM Research

Sep 2023 – May 2024

AI Analytics Researcher

- Benchmarked ResNet and U-Net across 6 analog AI hardware configurations, surfacing accuracy-performance tradeoffs to inform production deployment decisions.
- Co-authored 2 peer-reviewed papers (ICLR 2024 Notable, IJCAI 2024); presented findings to 200+ researchers at IBM/IEEE AICS 2023.

New York University

Oct – Dec 2025

Data Analytics Research Intern

- Analyzed 75+ HMXB time series using Python/scikit-learn pipelines to estimate orbital periods, frequencies and identification
- Reviewed 150+ research papers to compile orbital and stellar parameters for Magellanic Cloud HMXBs

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, SQL

Frameworks & Tools: React, Next.js, Node.js, FastAPI, REST APIs, Git/GitHub, Microsoft Office, Excel, PowerPoint

Data & ML: Pandas, scikit-learn, PyTorch, RAG, LLM APIs, Data Analysis, Model Evaluation

PROJECTS

Multi-Agent Investment Research System

2026

Python • Azure AI Foundry • Financial Analysis • Agentic AI

- Designed a 5-agent system producing a complete investment thesis from a single input — financial analysis, risk assessment, news synthesis, and strategic recommendation.

Are.na Visualizer

2026

TypeScript • Next.js • React • Are.na API

- Built an interactive visualization system transforming Are.na channel data into Canvas, Grid, and Disks views; designed reusable frontend components and state management across three visualization modes.

Wildfire Risk Modeling — AI Akhawayn University

2026

Python • Pandas • Geospatial Data • Machine Learning

- Built a pipeline to validate and preprocess 187K wildfire observations across 280 features with leakage-safe imputation and feature engineering.

PUBLICATIONS

Cherif et al. Analog In-Memory Computing with UQ for Edge Medical Imaging. ICLR 2024 (Notable).

Benmeziane, Cherif et al. Medical Neural Architecture Search: Survey and Taxonomy. IJCAI 2024, pp. 7932–7940.

LEADERSHIP & AWARDS

Leadership: TA, AI in Context — Columbia (Fall 2026) • NYU Business Analytics Club, Analyst • SEO Career Fellow — Tech/SWE • Girls Who Code, Associate • WiCS, Associate

Languages: English (native) • Arabic (native) • Italian (proficient) • Spanish (intermediate)

Awards: ICLR 2024 Notable Paper • IEEE WISC 2026 Scholar • Genius Olympiad Finalist • WESEF Finalist